HOME Choice and & MyCare Ohio Plans (MCOPs) Guidance

https://codes.ohio.gov/ohio-administrative-code/rule-5160-51-10
https://codes.ohio.gov/ohio-administrative-code/rule-5160-44-26

Purpose

The Ohio Department of Medicaid's (ODM) HOME Choice program assists eligible individuals in moving from institutional to community settings. The program works with other Medicaid services and community supports, including home and community-based services (HCBS) waiver programs. This document clarifies the roles of HOME Choice and MyCare of Ohio Plans (MCOPs) to support collaboration.

HOME Choice Eligibility

- Currently enrolled in Ohio Medicaid
- Have care needs that can be supported by community-based services
- 60-day or more institutional stay (nursing facility or hospital)
- Have income or a means of support in the community
- Must be at least 18 years of age
- Must agree to participate in an assessment
- Agree to HOME Choice participant responsibilities
- Move to housing compliant with the Home and Community-Based Settings rule (OAC 5160-44-01)

Referral

MCOP staff can refer any identified member requesting assistance with transitioning into the community to the HOME Choice program. The application can be found at https://medicaid.ohio.gov/families-and-individuals/citizen-programs-and-initiatives/hc/.

Services

- Transition Coordination (TC)
  - Two statewide transition coordination agencies, CareStar and National Church Residences, coordinate HOME Choice participants' transitions up to 180 calendar days prior to discharge and 30 calendar days post-discharge for both waiver and non-waiver individuals.
  - All individuals enrolled in HOME Choice are assigned a Transition Coordinator.
  - Transition Coordination is paid for by ODM Money Follows the Person (MFP) grant funds, NOT the MCOP.
- Community Transition Services (CTS)
  - CTS is a service offered through HOME Choice and the MyCare HCBS waiver.
  - CTS is available to individuals who are transitioning from a nursing facility or hospital to the community.
  - CTS Funds provide up to $2000 for non-recurring start-up living expenses to enable the establishment of a household that is reasonable and necessary.
  - CTS can be provided up to 180 calendar days prior to an individual's discharge from an institutional setting and 30 calendar days post-discharge.

MyCare Ohio Enrollees (Transitioning Without Waiver)	MyCare Ohio (Transitioning With MyCare Ohio Waiver)
TC submits initial CTS requests directly to ODM HOME Choice Community Living Administrators (CLA)	TC submits initial CTS requests via Waiver CTS Authorization form (ODM 10253) to the MyCare Ohio case manager or the plans' designated contact for CTS
CLA reviews requests and provides approval in ODM's system	Case manager/plan representative reviews requests, signs off on the initial CTS request form (ODM 10253) and returns it to the TC within 3 business days
TC coordinates and makes CTS purchases with the approved funds	TC coordinates and makes CTS purchases with the approved funds
TC submits receipts for procurement to the CLA	TC submits the final Waiver CTS form (ODM 10253) along with receipts for purchases made to the case manager.
CLA reviews receipts, provides approval and CTS is paid for by ODM HOME Choice Funds	Case Manager reviews receipts, completes and signs final Waiver CTS form (ODM 10253) and returns form to the TC. CTS is paid for by the MyCare Ohio Waiver. Pursuant to OAC 5160-44-26 A (3), If the individual fails to transition to an HCBS setting, the service is still payable if all other requirements are met.

Collaboration

The MCOP is automatically notified of HOME Choice enrollment or denial by ODM. If the member enrolls, the TC assignment is included in the notification. The MCOP is also notified if a member disenrolls from HOME Choice or is terminated prior to a successful transition. The MCOP may always outreach to HOME_Choice@medicaid.ohio.gov or 888-221-1560 for questions regarding an individual's eligibility.

1. Upon notification of HOME Choice enrollment, the MCOP is expected to outreach to the TC (if communication has not already occurred) to discuss transition needs.
2. The MCOP must assist the individual in completing a waiver application upon request from ODM, the member, or the TC. Please note, determining waiver eligibility is an integral part of the HOME Choice process to move forward with locating appropriate housing, plan for a future discharge, and open access to CTS funds. The MCOP is required to initiate the waiver assessment process upon request; the individual does not need a discharge date or housing secured to be assessed for the waiver. https://medicaid.ohio.gov/Portals/0/Resources/Publications/Forms/ODM02399fillx.pdf
    a. The PASSPORT Administrative Agency (PAA) typically completes the Level of Care Assessment (LOC) within 10 business days. If more than 90 days pass before all waiver enrollment criteria are met (including discharge), the MCOP may request a new LOC if there are changes to the member's health status. If no changes have occurred, the MCOP is not required to request a new LOC while awaiting discharge. Please note that a LOC every 30 days is not required.
3. For Members who are **not** found to meet the LOC for waiver services, follow steps below:
    a. The MCOP shall incorporate HOME Choice goals/activities into the individualized care plan.
    b. No later than 30 calendar days upon return to the community, the MCOP and TC will communicate to ensure that needs are met.
4. For Members who **are** found to meet the LOC, follow the steps below:
    a. The TC will request prior authorization from the MCOP for CTS via the "Waiver CTS

Authorization Template" (https://medicaid.ohio.gov/stakeholders-and-partners/legal-and-contracts/forms/forms) The MCOP will have 3 business days from the date the email request was sent to provide a response to the TC via the ODM form 10253. This process will be replicated as often as necessary to ensure all goods and services (within the $2,000 cap) required for a safe transition are addressed. Please note, the TC may make an expedited request.

b. The MCOP shall respond in accordance with OAC 5160-26-03.1 (http://codes.ohio.gov/oac/5160-26-03.1) with confirmation that the person-centered care plan has been updated, or with feedback on edits required and a request for resubmission.
c. The TC will spend accordance with the approved plan and retain receipts.
d. The MCOP will document all interactions in its care management system and update the person-center care plan as needed.
e. Upon discharge from the nursing facility or hospital, the MCOP and TC will maintain contact and review the discharge plan to ensure there are no gaps in service.
f. The TC shall send the final "Waiver CTS Authorization Template" (https://medicaid.ohio.gov/stakeholders-and-partners/legal-and-contracts/forms/forms) to the MCOP with receipts prior to the 30th calendar day post-discharge.
g. The MCOP shall reimburse authorized community transition service purchases upon receipt of the invoice on or after the date of discharge to the community. The date of the individual's waiver enrollment (discharge date) is the CTS service date.

5. For individuals who do not transition to the community, the MyCare Ohio plan is still responsible for signing the final Waiver CTS Authorization Template to account for any expenses incurred during their HOME Choice enrollment and for paying the CTS costs.

6. An individual's MyCare plan enrollment may change during the course of their HOME Choice program enrollment. The MyCare Ohio plan is also responsible for signing a final Waiver CTS Authorization Template and paying the CTS for any approved and utilized expenses during that MyCare plan enrollment, should the plan change during the course of HOME Choice participation. MyCare Ohio plans will honor any CTS expenses that were initially authorized by another MyCare Ohio plan or waiver (OHCW, PASSPORT, AL) when the purchase date occurred during the individual's enrollment on the current plan.